UPSC CSAT Paper II — Hard Simulation 1

Date: 2026-10-04 | Maximum Marks: 200 | Time: 120 minutes

Topics: Comprehension | Numeracy & DI | Logical/Analytical Ability | Decision-making

INSTRUCTIONS:

• 80 objective questions; each carries 2.5 marks. Maximum marks: 200.

• Time allowed: 120 minutes. Qualifying benchmark: 33% of 200 under the notified scheme; verify the current notification.

• Negative marking: one-third of the marks assigned to a question for a wrong answer; blank answers carry no penalty.

• This question paper is answer-free. Use the separately supplied answer key and solutions only after submission.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 1 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 1. Discussions of urban water resilience often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q1. Passage 1 is principally arguing that: Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q2. Passage 1 most clearly permits which inference? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q3. The reasoning in Passage 1 depends on which assumption? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q4. Which description most accurately characterises the tone of Passage 1? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 2 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 2. Discussions of technology adoption in small enterprises often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q5. Which interpretation most accurately states the main proposition of Passage 2? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q6. Which conclusion follows most securely from Passage 2? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q7. Which presupposition is required by the argument in Passage 2? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q8. Passage 2 adopts which overall rhetorical posture? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 3 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 3. Discussions of community-based forest governance often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q9. The central contention developed in Passage 3 is that: Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q10. Reading Passage 3 closely, which inference is justified? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q11. Passage 3 would be weakened most directly if which assumption failed? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q12. The authorial stance in Passage 3 is: Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 4 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 4. Discussions of the use of evidence in welfare delivery often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q13. With reference to Passage 4, which one of the following best captures its central claim? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q14. Which one of the following is most directly inferable from Passage 4? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q15. Which one of the following assumptions is necessary for the argument in Passage 4? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q16. The tone of Passage 4 is best described as: Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 5 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 5. Discussions of school learning recovery often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q17. Passage 5 is principally arguing that: Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q18. Passage 5 most clearly permits which inference? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q19. The reasoning in Passage 5 depends on which assumption? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q20. Which description most accurately characterises the tone of Passage 5? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION B — NUMERACY AND DATA INTERPRETATION (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q21. If r is the remainder when 5^18 + 6^16 is divided by 14, what is r? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q22. How many integers from 1 through 98, inclusive, are divisible by 7 or 12, but not by both? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q23. Solution A contains 27% solute and solution B contains 15% solute. If A and B are mixed in the volume ratio 6:1, what is the resulting concentration? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q24. Three independent teams complete a task in 16, 27 and 34 days respectively. Working together at constant rates, how many days are required? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q25. The average score of 23 candidates is 62. One score of 46 is replaced by 70. What is the new average? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q26. A quantity rises by 10%, falls by 21%, and then rises by 22%. What is the net percentage change? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q27. A rectangle of dimensions 13 m by 11 m has squares of side 3 m removed from its four corners. What area remains? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q28. A five-period index has values [11, 4, 6, 8, 10]; corresponding weights are [2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. What is the remainder when the weighted total is divided by 17? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q29. How many multiples of lcm(10, 10) lie in the inclusive interval [13, 47]? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q30. A sequence begins [2, 6, 8, 12]. Its successive increments are 4, 2, 4, 2, ... What is the next term? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q31. If r is the remainder when 5^19 + 6^17 is divided by 16, what is r? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q32. How many integers from 3 through 108, inclusive, are divisible by 10 or 13, but not by both? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q33. Solution A contains 22% solute and solution B contains 12% solute. If A and B are mixed in the volume ratio 8:1, what is the resulting concentration? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q34. Three independent teams complete a task in 17, 26 and 31 days respectively. Working together at constant rates, how many days are required? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q35. The average score of 24 candidates is 61. One score of 43 is replaced by 80. What is the new average? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q36. A quantity rises by 12%, falls by 22%, and then rises by 22%. What is the net percentage change? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q37. A rectangle of dimensions 15 m by 15 m has squares of side 4 m removed from its four corners. What area remains? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q38. A five-period index has values [3, 5, 7, 9, 11]; corresponding weights are [2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. What is the remainder when the weighted total is divided by 17? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q39. How many multiples of lcm(8, 13) lie in the inclusive interval [107, 423]? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q40. A sequence begins [4, 8, 12, 16]. Its successive increments are 4, 4, 4, 4, ... What is the next term? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION C — LOGICAL REASONING AND ANALYTICAL ABILITY (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q41. Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G sit in a row. C is third from the left; A is left of D; B and F are non-adjacent; G is not at an end. Which person cannot occupy fifth position? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q42. Six candidates P, Q, R, S, T and U are ranked first to sixth. P is above R, R above U, S above R, Q below S, and T is not first. Which candidate cannot be third? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q43. In a coding rule, each letter is replaced by its position multiplied by 4, then 3 is added and the result is reduced modulo 26 (A=0). What code is assigned to the letter whose position is 7? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q44. All members of set X are in Y; no member of Y is in Z; exactly 6 members are in X, 9 additional members are in Y but not X, and 8 members are outside Y. How many members are in Y? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q45. A field worker moves 8 km east and then 4 km north. What is the straight-line distance from the starting point, ignoring the path taken? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q46. M is the sister of N. N is the father of P. P is the daughter of Q. Relative to P, what is M? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q47. Exactly one of A, B and C is guilty and exactly one statement is true. A says B is guilty; B says A and C are innocent; C says B is innocent. Who is guilty? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q48. From 10 proposals, 5 are selected. Two specified proposals cannot be selected together. How many selections are possible? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q49. A team records 6 wins, 2 draws and 2 losses. With 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw and 0 for a loss, what is its points total? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q50. A committee must choose an ordered pair of distinct coordinators from 5 eligible members. How many ordered pairs are possible? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q51. Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G sit in a row. C is third from the left; A is left of D; B and F are non-adjacent; G is not at an end. Which person cannot occupy fifth position? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q52. Six candidates P, Q, R, S, T and U are ranked first to sixth. P is above R, R above U, S above R, Q below S, and T is not first. Which candidate cannot be third? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q53. In a coding rule, each letter is replaced by its position multiplied by 5, then 3 is added and the result is reduced modulo 26 (A=0). What code is assigned to the letter whose position is 7? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q54. All members of set X are in Y; no member of Y is in Z; exactly 4 members are in X, 9 additional members are in Y but not X, and 6 members are outside Y. How many members are in Y? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q55. A field worker moves 6 km east and then 4 km north. What is the straight-line distance from the starting point, ignoring the path taken? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q56. M is the sister of N. N is the father of P. P is the daughter of Q. Relative to P, what is M? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q57. Exactly one of A, B and C is guilty and exactly one statement is true. A says B is guilty; B says A and C are innocent; C says B is innocent. Who is guilty? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q58. From 10 proposals, 3 are selected. Two specified proposals cannot be selected together. How many selections are possible? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q59. A team records 4 wins, 3 draws and 2 losses. With 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw and 0 for a loss, what is its points total? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q60. A committee must choose an ordered pair of distinct coordinators from 5 eligible members. How many ordered pairs are possible? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION D — DECISION-MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q61. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A measurement conflicts with credible user reports before a sanction is proposed. What should precede action? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q62. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A public message must announce an uncertain hazard. Which communication is most responsible? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q63. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. Scarce services must be allocated between a larger population and a higher untreated-need rate. What rule is soundest? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q64. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A performance target encourages staff to close cases without resolving them. What correction is best? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q65. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A vocal association claims to represent everyone, but consultation attendance is narrow. What should follow? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q66. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A pilot produces mixed results across neighbourhoods. How should the administrator respond? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q67. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A grievance channel receives fewer complaints after a redesign. What is the most careful interpretation? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q68. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A contractor asks to relax a safety condition to meet a deadline. What should the officer do? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q69. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A beneficiary list contains duplicate names and some genuine exclusions. What is the right sequence? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q70. In a drought-prone taluk, a file concerning tank-restoration grants is being reviewed by panchayat engineers; the available evidence includes worksite measurements. A local leader requests an exception for one influential applicant. What is defensible? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q71. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A new digital process excludes some intended users. What should the officer do first? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q72. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. Two agencies submit conflicting records before a time-sensitive public intervention. What is the soundest next step? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q73. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A service reports high activity, but users say their underlying problems remain unresolved. Which measure should follow? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q74. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A fund can support a visible ceremony or a tested low-cost intervention. Which decision is stronger? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q75. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A lowest bid has a minor clerical error but no evidence of material advantage. What is fairest? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q76. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A measurement conflicts with credible user reports before a sanction is proposed. What should precede action? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q77. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A public message must announce an uncertain hazard. Which communication is most responsible? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q78. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. Scarce services must be allocated between a larger population and a higher untreated-need rate. What rule is soundest? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q79. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A performance target encourages staff to close cases without resolving them. What correction is best? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q80. In a tribal sub-division, a file concerning hostel attendance is being reviewed by education supervisors; the available evidence includes monthly attendance sheets. A vocal association claims to represent everyone, but consultation attendance is narrow. What should follow? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

— END OF QUESTION PAPER —

Total: 200 Marks | UPSC Practice Paper | Copilot CLI UPSC Agent